AOU
الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University
Faculty of Computer Studies

TM356
Interaction Design and User Experience

Midterm Examination (MTA)
FALL Semester 2025/2026

Date: 20/Nov./2025

Number of Exam Pages: 3 (including this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed:** 2 hours

Instructions:

- Total Marks: **60**
- This exam consists of **3** parts.
- **ALL questions** must be answered in the External Answer booklet.
- Be sure you write your **name and ID** on the External Answer booklet.
- **Calculators** are **not** allowed.

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PART 1: CHOOSE THE CORRECT ANSWERS FOR ALL QUESTIONS [10 Marks]

1. Affordance refers to the design feature that indicates how an object should be used. (.....)
2. A low-fidelity prototype is used for final usability testing before product release. (.....)
3. Visibility (or perceivability) helps users understand system status and available actions. (.....)
4. The consistency principle ensures that similar operations and elements behave similarly. (.....)
5. Personas are used to evaluate performance metrics of interactive systems. (.....)
6. Feedback allows users to assess the results of their actions and what steps to take next. (.....)
7. The cognitive load of a user increases when interface elements are predictable and consistent. (.....)
8. Contextual inquiry is a method for observing and interviewing users in their real environment. (.....)
9. Iteration in design means making repeated improvements based on feedback and evaluation. (.....)
10. Good interaction design focuses only on usability and ignores user experience aspects. (.....)

PART 2: ANSWER ALL QUESTIONS [20 Marks]

Question 1: [10 marks]

You are assigned to design a smart restaurant reservation system that allows users to book tables, browse menus, and receive digital receipts.

A) Explain one way to use direct observation and one way to use indirect observation to collect user requirements for this system. [6 marks]

B) Discuss two limitations of each method. [4 marks]

Question 2: [10 marks]

A) Define usability and user experience in the context of interaction design. [4 marks]

B) Explain three key differences between usability and user experience in terms of focus, evaluation, and user perception. [6 marks]

PART 3: ANSWER ALL QUESTIONS [30 marks]

Question 1: [15 marks]

You are a UX consultant reviewing "MediCare+," a healthcare mobile app that helps patients schedule appointments, access medical records, and receive medication reminders. Recently, users have complained about difficulty in locating features, confusing notifications, and lack of customization.

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A) Identify and explain three usability issues that users might face when using "MediCare+." [4.5 marks]
B) Discuss how these issues can affect user trust and engagement in a healthcare context. [1.5 marks]
C) Critically evaluate how the current design deviates from user-centered design principles. [2 marks]
D) Suggest three design improvements to enhance accessibility, trust, and ease of use. [3 marks]
E) Describe how these improvements could improve user satisfaction and long-term engagement. [2 marks]
F) Provide an example of how feedback and consistency can be applied to improve the app's usability. [2 marks]

Question 2: [15 marks]

You are developing a smart campus navigation app for university students and staff to locate buildings, services, and events.
A) Explain how you could apply contextual inquiry to gather user requirements. [4 marks]
B) Create a user persona for a typical student using this app (including name, age, goals, frustrations, and behaviors). [6 marks]
C) Describe three key accessibility features that would make the app inclusive for all students. [3 marks]
D) Explain how incorporating these features enhances the overall user experience. [2 marks]

End of questions

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